



NATIONAL SECURITY AGENCY CENTRAL SECURITY SERVICE

07 February 2025

Dzhakhongir Sharipov



Dear Dzhakhongir,

Congratulations on being one of the 30 student solvers of the 2024 National Security Agency Codebreaker Challenge. Completing the challenge required a mix of vulnerability analysis, cryptanalysis, and reverse-engineering skills. Your success demonstrated strong technical abilities in all of these areas, and is a significant accomplishment well worth celebrating. I commend your drive and determination to complete the challenge alongside your course workload. Well done!

The 2024 NSA Codebreaker Challenge provided students the opportunity to develop their reverse-engineering, vulnerability analysis, and cryptanalysis skills using a realistic scenario. Not all universities offer courses for students to learn the concepts, techniques, and tools involved in this craft.

Throughout the Challenge, NSA aimed to provide supplemental educational opportunities through the community of practice (Discord), and technical talks. I hope that you were able to learn new concepts, to strengthen and to develop new skills as a result of your participation.

Another goal of the challenge was to provide students with a closer look into some of the work being done at NSA. Every day, dedicated employees across the Agency apply deep technical knowledge to solve pressing challenges in areas such as cybersecurity and cryptography to support military operations, and counterterrorism. Although the specifics of this work are often classified, the backstory of the NSA Codebreaker Challenge was tailored to provide a realistic view of the NSA mission. I hope you enjoyed the opportunity to experience this type of work firsthand.

Please accept this NSA-branded medallion as a token of recognition for your achievement in the 2024 NSA Codebreaker Challenge. I wish you the best of luck in your future academic endeavors, and much success throughout your professional career.



Timothy D. Haugh
General, U.S. Air Force
Commander, U.S. Cyber Command
Director, National Security Agency
Chief, NSA Central Security Service

